

The Chapter Called 'The Great Festival in Which the Ocean of Bodhisattvas from the Ten Directions Gathers and Takes Delight,' from the Noble Sūtra of the Great Cloud

Ārya-mahāmegha-sūtra-daśadig-bodhisattva-samudrasannipāti-mahotsava-vikrīḍita-nāma-parivarta · Toh 233 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་སྒྲིམ་ཆེ་པའི་མདུན་ལོ་ས་ཡུལ་བཅའ་བྱ་ཆུ་སེམས་དཔའ་རྒྱ་ཆེ་འདུ་པའི་དཀར་སྒྲིམ་ཆེ་པ་
'ལ་རྒྱ་ཞེས་བྱའཁྱེད་ལྟེ

Toh 233 in the Kangyur is a chapter from the Noble Sūtra of the Great Cloud, known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-mahāmegha-sūtra and in Tibetan as Phags pa sprin chen po'i mdo, with this particular section bearing the title "The Great Festival in Which the Ocean of Bodhisattvas from the Ten Directions Gathers and Takes Delight." It is a Mahāyāna sūtra set on Vulture Peak Mountain at Rājagṛha, where the Buddha is depicted addressing an enormous assembly of monks, nuns, bodhisattvas, and laypeople. The text belongs to the sūtra division of the Kangyur and is presented as a discrete named chapter, or parivarta, of the larger Great Cloud collection. As suggested by both its title and its vast assembly scene, the work is concerned with the gathering and rejoicing of bodhisattvas from across the ten directions, situating it within the tradition of grand Mahāyāna scriptures that celebrate the scope and splendor of the bodhisattva path.

In the language of India: Ārya-mahāmegha-sūtra-daśadig-bodhisattva-samudrasannipāti-mahotsava-vikrīḍita-nāma-parivarta. In the language of Tibet: The Chapter Called "The Great Festival in Which the Ocean of Bodhisattvas from the Ten Directions Gathers and Takes Delight," from the Noble Sūtra of the Great Cloud.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling on Vulture Peak Mountain at Rājagṛha, together with a great Saṅgha of monks numbering eight hundred thousand, led by the great Kāśyapa; and with six hundred fifty thousand fully ordained nuns, led by the great Prajāpatī; and with six hundred eighty thousand bodhisattvas, led by the bodhisattva Mahāmegha-garbha; and with five hundred eighty thousand young Licchavī princes, led by Siṃha, all dwelling together in that assembly.

At that time, the divine sons of the four great heavenly kings — led by the Great King Dhṛtarāṣṭra and the other lords of the Four Great Kings — came in their hundreds of thousands, measureless and innumerable, to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side. Every one of those divine sons was none other than great bodhisattvas who were directly inclined toward the Great Vehicle and had properly entered the Great Vehicle.

At that time, from the realm of the Thirty-Three, the divine sons of the class of the Thirty-Three gods — led by Śakra (Indra), the lord of the gods — came in their hundreds of thousands, measureless and innumerable, to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side. Every one of those divine sons was none other than great bodhisattvas who were directly inclined toward the Great Vehicle and had properly entered the Great Vehicle.

At that time, from the class of the gods of the Heaven of Delighting in Emanations, the divine king Sunirmita and other divine sons came in their hundreds of thousands, measureless and innumerable, to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side. Every one of those divine sons was none other than great bodhisattvas who were directly inclined toward the Great Vehicle and had properly entered the Great Vehicle.

At that time, from the class of the gods who Wield Power over Others' Emanations, the divine king Vaśavartin and other divine sons came in their hundreds of thousands, measureless and innumerable, to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side. Every one of those divine sons was none other than great bodhisattvas who were directly inclined toward the Great Vehicle and had properly entered the Great Vehicle.

At that time, two hundred eighty thousand nāga kings, led by the nāga king Padmavān, each attended by an innumerable retinue of hundreds of thousands of nāgas, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side. Every one of those nāga kings was none other than a great bodhisattva who had attained a distinct meditative absorption.

At that time, three hundred sixty thousand yakṣa kings, led by the yakṣa king Vaiśravaṇa-putra, each attended by an innumerable retinue of hundreds of

thousands of yakṣas, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side.

Every one of those yakṣa kings was none other than a great bodhisattva who had attained a distinct meditative absorption.

At that time, two million eight hundred thousand gandharva kings (Skt. gandharva), led by the gandharva king Ānanda, each attended by an innumerable retinue of hundreds of thousands of gandharvas, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side. Every one of those gandharva kings was none other than a great bodhisattva who had attained a distinct meditative absorption.

At that time, eight million eight hundred thousand asura kings, led by the asura king Vemacitrin, each attended by an innumerable retinue of hundreds of thousands of asuras, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side. Every one of those asura kings was none other than a great bodhisattva who had attained a distinct meditative absorption.

At that time, four million nine hundred thousand garuḍa kings (Skt. garuḍa), led by the garuḍa king Fragrant Elephant, each attended by an innumerable retinue of hundreds of thousands of garuḍas, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side. Every one of those garuḍa kings was none other than a great bodhisattva who had attained a distinct meditative absorption.

At that time, nine million eight hundred thousand kinnara kings (Skt. kinnara), led by the kinnara king Sudarśana, each attended by an innumerable retinue of hundreds of thousands of kinnaras, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side. Every one of those kinnara kings was none other than a great bodhisattva who had attained a distinct meditative absorption.

At that time, many hundreds of thousands of mahoraga kings (Skt. mahoraga), led by the mahoraga king Virtue Moon, each attended by an innumerable retinue of hundreds of thousands of mahoragas, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side. Every one of those mahoraga

kings was none other than a great bodhisattva who had attained a distinct meditative absorption.

At that time, eight million eight hundred thousand rākṣasa kings (Skt. rākṣasa), led by the rākṣasa king Wilderness Dweller, each attended by an innumerable retinue of hundreds of thousands of rākṣasas, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side. Every one of those rākṣasa kings was none other than a great bodhisattva who had attained a distinct meditative absorption.

At that time, seven million eight hundred thousand kumbhāṇḍa kings (Skt. kumbhāṇḍa), led by the kumbhāṇḍa king Fervent, each attended by an innumerable retinue of hundreds of thousands of kumbhāṇḍas, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side.

Every one of those kumbhāṇḍa kings was none other than a great bodhisattva who had attained a distinct meditative absorption.

At that time, eight million kings of the Kacchanaka spirits, led by the Kacchanaka king Good Lightning, each attended by an innumerable retinue of hundreds of thousands of Kacchanaka spirits, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side. Every one of those Kacchanaka kings was none other than a great bodhisattva who had attained a distinct meditative absorption.

At that time, six million kings of the vidyādhara sorcerer-kings (Skt. vidyādhara), led by the vidyādhara king Jewel-Bearer, each attended by an innumerable retinue of hundreds of thousands of vidyādharas, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side.

At that time, three million eight hundred thousand kings of the elemental spirits, led by the elemental spirit king Elephant-Heart, each attended by an innumerable retinue of hundreds of thousands of elemental spirits, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side.

At that time, nine million sages (Skt. ṛṣi), led by the sage Ancestral Offering, every one of whom was endowed with the five higher knowledges (Skt.

abhiññā), came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side.

At that time, the Kosalan king Prasenajit, coming from the great city of Śrāvastī together with many hundreds of thousands of attendants and the fourfold army, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, he presented victory banners and pennants to the Tathāgata, bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, and took his place to one side.

At that time, the householder Supriya, coming from the land of Campā together with many hundreds of thousands of householders, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side.

At that time, people from every village, town, district, and royal palace of the sixteen lands came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side. Every one of them was none other than a great bodhisattva.

At that time, from the great city of Śrāvastī, sixty-six thousand queens, led by Queen Mālikā, and many hundreds of thousands of laywomen, led by the laywoman Sagalā, every one of whom had genuinely entered the Great Vehicle, bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side.

Many hundreds of thousands of young gods of the Pure Abodes, led by the young god Maheśvara, every one of those young gods being none other than a great bodhisattva who had attained a distinct meditative absorption, were also assembled there.

Many hundreds of thousands of Brahmā gods, led by Brahmā Jewel-Protector, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side.

Many hundreds of thousands of divine maidens, led by the divine maiden Graceful as a Water-Tree, had also gathered within that very assembly. As they danced and sang, each one of those divine maidens presented to the Tathāgata matchless parasols, victory banners, and pennants, offering them forth with great devotion.

they were overjoyed and filled with great delight, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side. All of those divine maidens, without exception, were nothing other than

great bodhisattvas who had passed beyond the faults of womanhood.

From each class of gods, many hundreds of thousands of divine maidens came dancing and singing, made their way to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they offered clouds of divine parasols, clouds of victory banners, and clouds of pennants to the Tathāgata, with joy and with great, overflowing delight. And being overjoyed and filled with great, overflowing delight, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side. All of those divine maidens, without exception, were nothing other than great bodhisattvas who had passed beyond the faults of womanhood.

At that same time, the monks who were dwelling in the various directions and intermediate directions also gathered into that very assembly. From that gathering they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side.

At that same time there were four great Wind Kings — namely, the great Wind King called Scattered Wind, the great Wind King called Great Scattered Wind, the great Wind King called Stainless Force, and the great Wind King called Greatly Attached — and together with flowers and all manner of fragrances they rose up, made their way to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they requested of the Blessed One the gateway to the Dharma-light of the lion's roar.

Many hundreds of thousands of great Cloud Kings came as well, sounding all varieties of songs and instrumental music and raining down showers of various precious jewels. They made their way to where the Blessed One was and, having arrived, requested the gateway to the Dharma-light of the lion's roar.

At that same time, countless hundreds of thousands of Swan Kings, led by the Swan King Courageous Hero, each attended by many hundreds of thousands of swan followers, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they praised the Blessed One with incomparable swan voices, then bowed their heads at his feet and took their places to one side. All of those Swan Kings were nothing other than great bodhisattvas delighting in distinct meditative absorptions.

At that same time, countless hundreds of thousands of Peacock Kings, led by the Peacock King Well-Seen, each attended by countless hundreds of thousands of peacock followers, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they extolled the Blessed One with melodious peacock cries,

then bowed their heads at his feet and took their places to one side. All of those Peacock Kings were nothing other than great bodhisattvas delighting in distinct meditative absorptions.

At that same time, countless hundreds of thousands of Cuckoo Kings, led by the Cuckoo King Host, each attended by countless hundreds of thousands of cuckoo followers, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they praised the Blessed One with melodious cuckoo calls and took their places to one side. All of those Cuckoo Kings were nothing other than great bodhisattvas delighting in distinct meditative absorptions.

At that same time, countless hundreds of thousands of kalavinka kings, led by the kalavinka king Lotus-Petal Eyes, each attended by countless hundreds of thousands of kalavinka followers, sounding their melodious kalavinka calls, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived —

praised the Blessed One with true praises of the buddha's qualities, and having praised him, they took their places to one side. All of those Kalavinka Kings were nothing other than great bodhisattvas delighting in distinct meditative absorptions.

At that same time, the Śaṅśaṅṭeu bird kings, led by the Śaṅśaṅṭeu king Victorious One, countless hundreds of thousands of Śaṅśaṅṭeu kings in all, each attended by countless hundreds of thousands of Śaṅśaṅṭeu followers, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they praised the Blessed One, the Bhagavān, with melodious divine calls, bowed their heads to the feet of the Blessed One, and took their places to one side. All of those Śaṅśaṅṭeu kings were nothing other than great bodhisattvas delighting in distinct meditative absorptions.

At that same time, from among countless different kinds of mixed bird species, within each distinct species there were countless hundreds of thousands of bird kings, and each of those bird kings, attended by countless hundreds of thousands of bird followers, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they honored the Blessed One openly with praises of the buddha's true qualities, expressed through the incomparable melodies of their own bird songs, bowed their heads to the feet of the Blessed One, and took their places to one side. All of those birds of mixed species were nothing other than great bodhisattvas delighting in distinct meditative absorptions.

At that same time, the Lion Kings, led by the Lion King Precious Lotus, countless hundreds of thousands of Lion Kings in all, each attended by

countless hundreds of thousands of lion followers, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they praised the Blessed One with true praises of the buddha's qualities, expressed through the melodious sound of lion roars, bowed their heads to the feet of the Blessed One, and took their places to one side. All of those Lion Kings were nothing other than great bodhisattvas delighting in distinct meditative absorptions.

At that same time, the Fragrant Elephant Kings, led by the Fragrant Elephant King named One Like the Snows of Rikā, countless hundreds of thousands of Fragrant Elephant Kings in all, each attended by countless hundreds of thousands of fragrant elephant followers, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they praised the Blessed One with true praises of the buddha's qualities, bowed their heads to the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated him three times, and took their places to one side. All of those fragrant elephants were nothing other than great bodhisattvas delighting in distinct meditative absorptions.

At that same time, all the snakes, tigers, and various intermingled kinds of deer came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads to the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side. All of those snakes, tigers, and deer were nothing other than great bodhisattvas delighting in distinct meditative absorptions, turned toward the Great Vehicle and truly entered into it.

At that same time, wasps, mosquitoes, bees, biśuka insects, fish, frogs, the water-spirit that devours children, the sesara insect, owls, wicked ones, and countless multitudes upon multitudes of insect species, along with all manner of intermingled venomous snakes, as well as pigs, dogs, foxes, and other small creatures as well, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they openly praised the Blessed One with true praises of the buddha's qualities —

They bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side. At that same time, snakes — swift in their venom, the zigu serpents, and countless hundreds of thousands upon hundreds of thousands of species of unbearably venomous serpents — came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they openly praised the buddha, the Blessed One, with true praises of the buddha's qualities. They bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side. All those gods too delighted in nothing other than the distinct meditative absorptions of the great

bodhisattvas.

At that same time, the gods of the Lhunpo mountains and the Great Lhunpo mountains, the Tang-zung mountains and the Great Tang-zung mountains, the encircling mountains and the great encircling mountains, and the gods of other mountains as well, each entered their own abodes and then came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they openly praised the Blessed One with true praises of the buddha's qualities. They bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side. All those gods too delighted in nothing other than the distinct meditative absorptions of the great bodhisattvas.

At that same time, all the gods of medicinal plants and of forests, each entering their own abodes, came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they praised the Blessed One with true praises of the buddha's qualities. They bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and took their places to one side. All those gods too delighted in nothing other than the distinct meditative absorptions of the great bodhisattvas.

At that same time, the retinue of the great bodhisattva Meghamahāgarbha, along with certain other bodhisattvas, thought to themselves: "How is one to comprehend the fact that in a single moment the Blessed One sets in motion oceans of eons — oceans of eons that are immeasurable, countless, inconceivable, incomparable, immeasurable, boundless, inexpressible, and beyond even that which is inexpressible? How many are the eons of the Blessed One's complete and perfect awakening? Entering into all the defiled world-realms of the ten directions through the ways of worldly conduct, guided by skill in manifold methods of skillful means, and deploying the power of blessing through wisdom, vision, elements, causes, objects of focus, definitive words, designation, and systematic presentation — through all these, however vast an ocean of sentient beings there may be, may the Blessed One ripen them all in unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening."

At that same time, the great bodhisattva Sarvāvaraṇaviṣkambhin, having been granted permission by the Buddha, and having attained fearlessness, knew with his mind the complete range of thoughts in the minds of those great bodhisattvas. He then addressed the great bodhisattva Meghamahāgarbha in these words: "Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing Birth in the Tuṣita Heaven of the Tathāgatas.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dwelling in the Tuṣita Heaven of the Tathāgatas.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Passing and Transmigration from the Tuṣita Heaven of the Tathāgatas.'"

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Birth of the Tathāgatas into the Womb of the Goddess of Magical Illusion.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Appearance of the Subtle Presence of the Tathāgatas within the Womb of the Goddess of Magical Illusion.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Birth of the Tathāgatas in the Lumbinī Grove.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dwelling of the Tathāgatas in the Lumbinī Grove.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Gazing in All Directions of the Tathāgatas in the Lumbinī Grove.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Speaking of Words of the Tathāgatas in the Lumbinī Grove.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Proceeding of the Tathāgatas from the Lumbinī Grove to the Great City of Kapilavastu.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Coming of the Great Lord to Pay Homage to the Tathāgatas.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing by Means of the Powers of the Tathāgatas.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Sport of

Childhood of the Tathāgatas.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Proceeding of the Tathāgatas to the School Where Letters Are Learned.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Learning of Letters, Treatises, Arithmetic, Calculation, and Composition by the Tathāgatas.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Training of the Tathāgatas in Winning the Hand of the Śākya Maiden Yaśodharā.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dwelling of the Tathāgatas within the Queen's Retinue.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Proceeding of the Tathāgatas to the Place of the Pleasure Grove.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Old Age, Sickness, Death, and

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Beholding of the Going Forth of the Tathāgatas.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Manifest Departure of the Tathāgatas from the Great City of Kapilavastu for the Sake of Their Going Forth.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Donning of the Ochre Robe by the Tathāgatas.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dwelling of the Tathāgatas in the Practice of Austerities.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Rising of the Tathāgatas from the Practice of Austerities.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Bathing of the

Tathāgatas.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Partaking of Food by the Tathāgatas.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Proceeding of the Tathāgatas to the Seat of Awakening.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Sitting of the Tathāgatas at the Seat of Awakening.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Summoning of Māra by the Tathāgatas.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Taming of Māra by the Tathāgatas.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Complete Manifest Awakening of the Tathāgatas.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Invitation to Turn the Wheel of Dharma by the Tathāgatas.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Turning of the Wheel of Dharma in Twelve Aspects by the Tathāgatas Three Times Over.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Light of Fire, the Light of Lightning, the Moon, the Light of the Sun, the Light of Jewels, Śakra (Indra), Brahmā, and the Light of the World-Protectors of the Tathāgatas.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Royal Proclamation of the Tathāgatas.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Four Lineages of the Tathāgatas.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Blind, the Lame, the Mute, and the Deaf.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning Rebirth in the Hell Realms, Among Animals, Among Hungry Ghosts, and in the World of Yama, Lord of Death.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning Rebirth in the Various States of Lacking Leisure.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Path of the Ten Virtuous Actions.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Various Objects of Meritorious Activity.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Conduct, the Wanderings, and the Non-Buddhists Such as the Naked Ascetics.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Disturbance of the Eighty-Four Poisons.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Disturbance of Thieves.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Disturbance of the Disease of Finger-Garland.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Disturbance of Yakṣas Dwelling in the Wilderness.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Disturbance of the Nāga King Who Is Without Grass.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Disturbance of Famine.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Disturbance of Bandits.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Disturbance of Human Enemies.' Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Disturbance of Blazing Sand in the Abodes of the Nāgas.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Disturbance of Garuḍas in the Abodes of the Nāgas.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Disturbance of Schism in the Saṅgha.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Disturbance of Hurling and Placing of Rocks.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Disturbance of Elephants Entering with Their Tusks.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Disturbance of Brahmin Women Who Practice Deception.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Disturbance of Wanderers Stirred Up by a Beautiful Wanderess Who Imposes False Accusations.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Slaying of the Śākya.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Deeds to Be Performed by the Śrāvakas.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Deeds to Be Performed with One's Own Body.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of the Three Vehicles.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of Fears.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of What Has Become a View.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of False Imputations.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of Directing to Action.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of

What Is to Be Adopted and What Is to Be Abandoned.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of Lifting Up and Setting Down.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of Conditioned Phenomena.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of the Four Things.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of Abiding Place.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of Things.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of the Two.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of Defining Characteristics.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of Objects of Focus.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing

Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of Extremes.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of the Body.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of the Retinue.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of the Inexpressible.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of Complete Affliction.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of Attachment.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of Conceit.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of Existence.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of Names.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of Self.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of Causes and Conditions.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of Mixture.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of Script.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of the Absence of Pride.'

Meghamahāgarbha, within the Great Cloud Sūtra there exists a gateway to the manifestation of Dharma called 'Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Tathāgatas' Dispensation Concerning the Establishment of the Inconceivable Domain.'

And so forth — the gateways to the manifestation of Dharma of the Tathāgatas are as numerous as ten million hundreds of thousands of times the grains of sand in the Ganges River.

At that moment, from the ūrṇā-hair of the Blessed One there issued forth immeasurable circles of rays of light called 'The Lineage Free from Attachment, Free from Fear.' These rays pervaded all the world-systems, boundless as space, in the ten directions with a great radiance, utterly overwhelmed all the abodes of Māra, revealed the supreme gathering of buddhas, ripened the infinite realm of sentient beings toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and then returned. Having circled the Tathāgata an incalculable number of times, they came to rest upon the body of the

bodhisattva Samantabhadra.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Samantabhadra, having attained fearlessness, rose from his seat, arranged his robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee upon the ground, and with palms pressed together bowed in the direction of the Blessed One, and addressed the Blessed One in these words:

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Birth in the Tuṣita Heaven, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Dwelling in the Tuṣita Heaven, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Passage of Death, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Entering the Womb of the Goddess Māyā, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Appearing as a Subtle Form in the Womb of the Goddess Māyā, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Being Born in the Lumbinī Grove, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Taking Steps in the Lumbinī Grove, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Gazing in the Four Directions in the Lumbinī Grove, gather

into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Uttering Speech in the Lumbinī Grove, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Proceeding from the Lumbinī Grove to the Great City of Kapilavastu, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Going to Pay Homage to the Great Lord (Śiva), gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Display of Strength, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Sports and Games of Youth, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Going to the Hall Where Letters Are Studied, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Training in Letters, Treatises, Arithmetic, Calculation, and Composition, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Achieving the Training of Winning the Hand of the Śākya Maiden Gopā, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Dwelling in the Queen's Retinue, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Proceeding from the Great City of Kapilavastu to the Pleasure Grove, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Beholding the Old, the Sick, and the Dead, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Proceeding Forth from Renunciation, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Going Forth from the Great City of Kapilavastu, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Accepting the Saffron Robe, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Abiding in the Practice of Austerities, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Rising from the Practice of Austerities, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Bathing, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Partaking of Food, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Proceeding to the Seat of Awakening, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Abiding at the Seat of Awakening, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Summoning Māra, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Taming Māra, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Fully and Perfectly Awakening, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Being Requested to Turn the Wheel of Dharma, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Turning the Wheel of Dharma in Twelve Aspects, Recited Three Times, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Radiance of Fireflies, the Radiance of Lightning, the Radiance of the Moon and Sun, the Radiance of Jewels, the Radiance of Śakra

(Indra, king of the gods), the Radiance of Brahmā, and the Radiance of the World-Protectors, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Royal Proclamation, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Four Castes, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Blind, the Lame, the Mute, and the Deaf, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Birth in the Hells, among Animals, among Hungry Ghosts, and in the World of Yama, Lord of Death, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Birth in the Various States of Misfortune Afflicted by Defilements throughout All the World-Realms of the Ten Directions, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Path of the Ten Virtuous Actions of Karma, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Various Bases for Performing Merit, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Wandering Ascetics, the Peripatetics, the Naked Ones,

and other such non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Stirring Up of the Eighty-Four Poisons, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Stirring Up of All Robbers, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Stirring Up of a Garland of Fingers, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Stirring Up of Yakṣas Dwelling in the Wilderness, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Stirring Up of Sogma-me, King of the Nāgas, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Stirring Up of Famine, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Stirring Up of Thieves, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Stirring Up of Brazen Men, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Stirring Up of Blazing Sand in the Afflicted Nāga Abodes throughout all the world-realms of the ten directions, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Stirring Up of Garuḍas in the Nāga Abodes, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Stirring Up of Schism in the Saṅgha, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of Hurling and Placing Rocks, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Stirring Up of Elephants Driven by Wealth, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Brahmin Girl Who Deceives and Stirs Up All, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Wanderer Adorned with Beautiful Feathers Who Stirs Up All, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Slaying of the Śākya Who Stirs Up All, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Task of the Hearers, gather into this assembly those

bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

May the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Dispensation of the Task Pertaining to One's Own Body, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, the path is singular — there is no second or third. Throughout all the world systems of the ten directions the path is equally singular — there is no second or third. Since this is the nature of reality, may the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Three Vehicles for Those Who Are Afflicted throughout all the world systems in the ten directions, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without destruction — destruction is what is perfectly pure. Why is this? Because there is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of destruction. Apart from the intrinsic nature of destruction, there is no other non-destruction; rather, the intrinsic nature of destruction itself is non-destruction. One who knows non-destruction through the intrinsic nature of destruction knows that all phenomena are without destruction. Therefore, may the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing Destruction, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are empty — what has come to be seen is perfectly pure. Why is this? Because there is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of what has come to be seen. Emptiness is not other than the intrinsic nature of what has come to be seen; rather, the intrinsic nature of what has come to be seen is itself emptiness. One who knows emptiness through the intrinsic nature of what has come to be seen knows that all phenomena are empty. Therefore, may the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing What Has Come to Be Seen, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without superimposition — superimposition is what is perfectly pure. Why is this? Because there is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of superimposition. Apart from the intrinsic nature of superimposition, there is no other absence of superimposition; rather, the

intrinsic nature of superimposition itself is the absence of superimposition.

One who knows, through the intrinsic nature of superimposition, that superimposition is absent — by that knowledge all phenomena are without superimposition. Therefore, may the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing Superimposition, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without appointment to a task — appointment to a task is what is perfectly pure. Why is this? Because there is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of appointment to a task. Apart from the intrinsic nature of appointment to a task, there is no other absence of appointment to a task; rather, the intrinsic nature of appointment to a task itself is the absence of appointment to a task. One who knows, through the intrinsic nature of appointment to a task, that appointment to a task is absent — by that knowledge all phenomena are without appointment to a task. Therefore, may the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing Appointment to a Task, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without adoption and rejection — adoption and rejection is what is perfectly pure. Why is this? Because there is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of adoption and rejection. Apart from the intrinsic nature of adoption and rejection, there is no other absence of adoption and rejection; rather, the intrinsic nature of adoption and rejection itself is the absence of adoption and rejection. One who knows, through the intrinsic nature of adoption and rejection, that adoption and rejection is absent — by that knowledge all phenomena are without adoption and rejection. Therefore, may the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing Adoption and Rejection, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without lifting and placing — lifting and placing is what is perfectly pure. Why is this? Because there is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of lifting and placing. Apart from the intrinsic nature of lifting and placing, there is no other absence of lifting and placing; rather, the intrinsic nature of lifting and placing itself is the absence of lifting and placing. One who knows, through the intrinsic nature of lifting and placing,

that lifting and placing is absent — by that knowledge all phenomena are without lifting and placing. Therefore, may the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing Lifting and Placing, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are unconditioned — the conditioned is what is perfectly pure. Why is this? Because there is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of the conditioned. Apart from the intrinsic nature of the conditioned, there is no other unconditioned; rather, the intrinsic nature of the conditioned itself is the unconditioned. One who knows, through the intrinsic nature of the conditioned, that the unconditioned is — by that knowledge all phenomena are unconditioned. Therefore, may the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Conditioned, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without a main object — the main object is what is perfectly pure. Why is this? Because there is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of the main object.

The absence of a main object is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of the main object itself. It is the very intrinsic nature of the main object that is the absence of a main object. One who knows, through the intrinsic nature of the main object, that there is no main object — by that knowledge all phenomena are without a main object. Therefore, may the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Main Object, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without a basis — the basis is what is perfectly pure. Why is this? Because there is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of the basis. The absence of a basis is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of the basis itself. It is the very intrinsic nature of the basis that is the absence of a basis. One who knows, through the intrinsic nature of the basis, that there is no basis — by that knowledge all phenomena are without a basis. Therefore, may the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Basis, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without an entity — the entity is what is perfectly pure. Why is this? Because there is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of the entity. The absence of an entity is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of the entity itself. It is the very intrinsic nature of the entity that is the absence of an entity. One who knows, through the intrinsic nature of the entity, that there is no entity — by that knowledge all phenomena are without an entity. Therefore, may the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Entity, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without duality — duality is what is perfectly pure. Why is this? Because there is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of duality. The absence of duality is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of duality itself. It is the very intrinsic nature of duality that is the absence of duality. One who knows, through the intrinsic nature of duality, that there is no duality — by that knowledge all phenomena are without duality. Therefore, may the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing Duality, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without a defining characteristic — the defining characteristic is what is perfectly pure. Why is this? Because there is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of the defining characteristic. The absence of a defining characteristic is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of the defining characteristic itself. It is the very intrinsic nature of the defining characteristic that is the absence of a defining characteristic. One who knows, through the intrinsic nature of the defining characteristic, that there is no defining characteristic — by that knowledge all phenomena are without a defining characteristic. Therefore, may the Blessed One, by the Application of the Power of Blessing Establishing the Defining Characteristic, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without a referent object — the referent object is what is perfectly pure. Why is this? Because there is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of the referent object. The absence of a referent object is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of the referent object itself. It is the very intrinsic nature of the referent object that is the absence of a referent object. One who knows, through the intrinsic nature of the referent

object —

one who knows the absence of a referent object — since all phenomena are without a referent object — may the Blessed One, through the power of the blessing of establishing the referent object, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are the Middle Way — they are perfectly pure of extremes. Why is this? Because there is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of the extremes. The Middle Way is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of the extremes; the intrinsic nature of the extremes itself is the Middle Way. One who knows the Middle Way through the intrinsic nature of the extremes — since all phenomena are the Middle Way — may the Blessed One, through the power of the blessing of establishing the extremes, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without a body — body is what is perfectly pure. Why is this? Because there is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of body. The absence of body is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of body itself; the intrinsic nature of body itself is the absence of body. One who knows the absence of body through the intrinsic nature of body — since all phenomena are without a body — may the Blessed One, through the power of the blessing of establishing body, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without saṃsāra — saṃsāra is what is perfectly pure. Why is this? Because there is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of saṃsāra. The absence of saṃsāra is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of saṃsāra itself; the intrinsic nature of saṃsāra itself is the absence of saṃsāra. One who knows the absence of saṃsāra through the intrinsic nature of saṃsāra — since all phenomena are without saṃsāra — may the Blessed One, through the power of the blessing of establishing saṃsāra, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without inexpressibility — inexpressibility is what is perfectly pure. Why is this? Because there is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of inexpressibility. The absence of inexpressibility is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of inexpressibility itself; the intrinsic nature of

inexpressibility itself is the absence of inexpressibility. One who knows the absence of inexpressibility through the intrinsic nature of inexpressibility — since all phenomena are without inexpressibility — may the Blessed One, through the power of the blessing of establishing inexpressibility, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without thorough defilement — thorough defilement is what is perfectly pure. Why is this? Because there is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of thorough defilement. The absence of thorough defilement is nothing other than the intrinsic nature of thorough defilement itself; the intrinsic nature of thorough defilement itself is the absence of thorough defilement. One who knows the absence of thorough defilement through the intrinsic nature of thorough defilement — since all phenomena are without thorough defilement — may the Blessed One, through the power of the blessing of establishing thorough defilement, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without attachment; attachment is thoroughly pure. Why is that? Because the absence of attachment is not other than the intrinsic nature of attachment itself. The absence of attachment is not something separate from the intrinsic nature of attachment; the intrinsic nature of attachment itself is the absence of attachment. One who knows the absence of attachment through the intrinsic nature of attachment — since all phenomena are without attachment — may the Blessed One, through the power of the blessing of establishing attachment, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without conceit; conceit is thoroughly pure. Why is that? Because the absence of conceit is not other than the intrinsic nature of conceit itself. The absence of conceit is not something separate from the intrinsic nature of conceit; the intrinsic nature of conceit itself is the absence of conceit. One who knows the absence of conceit through the intrinsic nature of conceit — since all phenomena are without conceit — may the Blessed One, through the power of the blessing of establishing conceit, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without existence; existence is thoroughly pure. Why is that? Because the absence of existence is not other than the intrinsic nature of existence itself. The absence of existence is not something separate from the intrinsic nature of existence; the intrinsic nature of existence itself is the absence of existence. One who knows the absence of existence through the intrinsic nature of existence — since all phenomena are without existence — may the Blessed One, through the power of the blessing of establishing existence, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without name; name is thoroughly pure. Why is that? Because the absence of name is not other than the intrinsic nature of name itself. The absence of name is not something separate from the intrinsic nature of name; the intrinsic nature of name itself is the absence of name. One who knows the absence of name through the intrinsic nature of name — since all phenomena are without name — may the Blessed One, through the power of the blessing of establishing name, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without self; self is thoroughly pure. Why is that? Because the absence of self is not other than the intrinsic nature of self itself. The intrinsic nature of self is not something separate from the intrinsic nature of the absence of self; the intrinsic nature of self itself is the absence of self. One who knows the absence of self through the intrinsic nature of self — since all phenomena are without self — may the Blessed One, through the power of the blessing of establishing self, gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been established in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without the activity of causes and conditions; the activity of causes and conditions is thoroughly pure. Why is that? Because the absence of the activity of causes and conditions is not other than the intrinsic nature of the activity of causes and conditions itself. The absence of the activity of causes and conditions is not something separate from the intrinsic nature of the activity of causes and conditions; the intrinsic nature of the activity of causes and conditions itself is the absence of the activity of causes and conditions.

One who knows, through the intrinsic nature of the activity of causes and conditions, that the activity of causes and conditions is absent — such a one knows that all phenomena are without the activity of causes and conditions. Therefore, we implore the Blessed One, through the power of the blessing of establishing the activity of causes and conditions, to gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been set on the path to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without mixture; mixture is thoroughly pure. Why is that? Because the absence of mixture is not other than the intrinsic nature of mixture itself. The absence of mixture is not something separate from the intrinsic nature of mixture; the intrinsic nature of mixture itself is the absence of mixture. One who knows, through the intrinsic nature of mixture, that mixture is absent — such a one knows that all phenomena are without mixture. Therefore, we implore the Blessed One, through the power of the blessing of establishing mixture, to gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been set on the path to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without letters; letters are thoroughly pure. Why is that? Because the absence of letters is not other than the intrinsic nature of letters itself. The absence of letters is not something separate from the intrinsic nature of letters; the intrinsic nature of letters itself is the absence of letters. One who knows, through the intrinsic nature of letters, that letters are absent — such a one knows that all phenomena are without letters. Therefore, we implore the Blessed One, through the power of the blessing of establishing letters, to gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been set on the path to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without the absence of pride; the absence of pride is thoroughly pure. Why is that? Because the absence of the absence of pride is not other than the intrinsic nature of the absence of pride itself. The absence of the absence of pride is not something separate from the intrinsic nature of the absence of pride; the intrinsic nature of the absence of pride itself is the absence of pride. One who knows, through the intrinsic nature of the absence of pride, that the absence of pride is absent — such a one knows that all phenomena are without the absence of pride. Therefore, we implore the Blessed One, through the power of the blessing of establishing the absence of pride, to gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been set on the path to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Blessed One, all phenomena are without inconceivable objects; inconceivable objects are thoroughly pure. Why is that? Because the absence of inconceivable objects is not other than the intrinsic nature of inconceivable objects itself. The absence of inconceivable objects is not something separate from the intrinsic nature of inconceivable objects; the intrinsic nature of inconceivable objects itself is the absence of inconceivable objects. One who knows, through the intrinsic nature of inconceivable objects, that inconceivable objects are absent — such a one knows that all phenomena are without inconceivable objects. Therefore, we implore the Blessed One, through the power of the blessing of establishing inconceivable objects throughout all the defiled world-realms of the ten directions, to gather into this assembly those bodhisattvas who have been set on the path to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

In the same way, one should enter through the countless gateways of emptiness that function as mutual antidotes, entering in the manner of mixture.

We implore the Blessed One, through the power of the blessing of worldly conduct skillfully adapted through manifold means — along with gnosis, vision, elements, causes, objects of focus, definitive words, designations, and established formulations — by which bodhisattvas ripen toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening ocean-like multitudes of sentient beings throughout all the defiled world-realms of the ten directions, to gather those bodhisattvas into this assembly.

Having made this entreaty, the Blessed One understood in his heart the heightened aspiration of that assembly. Knowing the wish of the bodhisattvas of the ten directions to behold one another, he fulfilled their aspiration. And in order to gather those bodhisattvas together, from the soles of his two feet he released ocean-clouds of light-rays pervading an ocean of world-realms equal in number to the finest particles of dust in fifty Ganges rivers, each such particle multiplied by a hundred thousand koṭis, by a trillion, by an incalculable number. Likewise from each joint of the toes of both feet, and likewise from both ankles, and likewise from both kneecaps, and likewise from both thighs, and likewise from both hips, and likewise from both sides of the torso, and likewise from the navel cavity, and likewise from both shoulders, and likewise from both shoulder-joints, and likewise from both upper arms, and likewise from both palms, and likewise from each joint of the fingers of both hands, and

likewise from the crown protrusion, and likewise from the tuft of hair between the brows, and likewise from each individual hair of the head, and likewise from each major mark, and likewise from each excellent minor mark, and likewise from each pore — from all of these as well he released ocean-clouds of light-rays pervading an ocean of world-realms equal in number to the finest particles of dust in fifty Ganges rivers, each such particle multiplied by a hundred thousand koṭis, by a trillion, by an incalculable number, and these radiated toward the east.

From a single one of those light-rays alone, an ocean of world-realms equal in number to the finest particles of dust in fifty Ganges rivers, each such particle multiplied by a hundred thousand koṭis, by a trillion, by an incalculable number, was pervaded by a great radiance; and the ocean of world-realms pervaded by that single ray was not also pervaded by a second ray.

Just as it was in the east, so too in the south, the west, and the north; and likewise in the northeast, the southeast, the southwest, the northwest, and likewise in the directions above and below — all those ocean-clouds of light-rays radiated out. And from a single one of those light-rays alone, an ocean of world-realms equal in number to the finest particles of dust in fifty Ganges rivers, each such particle multiplied by a hundred thousand koṭis, by a trillion, by an incalculable number, was pervaded by a great radiance; and the ocean of world-realms pervaded by that one ray was not also pervaded by a second.

Then, at that very time, from each of those world-realms in the eastern direction that had been illuminated by those light-rays, there arrived an ocean of bodhisattvas — an ocean of world-realms' worth of bodhisattvas, equal in number to the finest particles of dust in fifty Ganges rivers, each such particle multiplied by a hundred thousand koṭis, by a trillion, by an incalculable number. And the retinue of each individual bodhisattva likewise comprised an ocean of bodhisattvas — an ocean of world-realms' worth, equal in number to the finest particles of dust in fifty Ganges rivers, each such particle multiplied by a hundred thousand koṭis, by a trillion, by an incalculable number.

And what need is there even to speak of a retinue of great bodhisattvas equal in number to the finest particles of dust in an ocean of twenty-five world-realms, each such particle multiplied by a hundred thousand koṭis, by a trillion, by an incalculable number? What need to speak of a retinue of great bodhisattvas equal in number to the finest particles of dust in ten

buddha-fields, each such particle multiplied by a hundred thousand koṭis, by a trillion, by an incalculable number? What need to speak of a retinue equal in number to the finest particles of dust in ten buddha-fields, each such particle multiplied by a hundred thousand koṭis, by a trillion, by an inexpressible number? What need to speak of a retinue equal in number to the finest particles of dust in a hundred thousand world-realms? What need to speak of a retinue equal in number to the finest particles of dust in a thousand world-realms? What need to speak of a retinue equal in number to the finest particles of dust in fifty world-realms? What need to speak of a retinue equal in number to the finest particles of dust in twenty-five world-realms? What need to speak of a retinue equal in number to the finest particles of dust in ten world-realms? What need to speak of a retinue equal in number to the finest particles of dust in five world-realms? What need to speak of a retinue equal in number to the finest particles of dust in a single world-realm? What need to speak of a retinue equal in number to the grains of sand in a hundred Ganges rivers? What need to speak of a retinue equal in number to the grains of sand in fifty Ganges rivers? What need to speak of a retinue equal in number to the grains of sand in twenty-five Ganges rivers? What need to speak of a retinue equal in number to the grains of sand in ten Ganges rivers? What need to speak of a retinue equal in number to the grains of sand in five Ganges rivers? What need to speak of a retinue equal in number to the grains of sand in a single Ganges river? What need to speak of a retinue equal in number to one quarter of the grains of sand in a Ganges river? What need to speak of a retinue equal in number to one eighth of the grains of sand in a Ganges river? What need to speak of a retinue equal in number to one sixteenth of the grains of sand in a Ganges river? What need to speak of a retinue equal in number to one twentieth of the grains of sand in a Ganges river? What need to speak of a retinue of a hundred koṭis? What need to speak of a retinue of fifty koṭis? What need to speak of a retinue of twenty-five koṭis? What need to speak of a retinue of ten koṭis? What need to speak of a retinue of five koṭis? Indeed, what need is there even to speak of a retinue of a single great bodhisattva?

All those great bodhisattvas made their way to where the Blessed One was. And each individual great bodhisattva released — raining down over a space equal to ten great trichiliocosms — an uncountable, inexpressible ocean-mass of merit in the form of clouds of the sovereign lord of precious jewels, filling the sky without attachment, without obstruction, and without mingling. Having thus released that rain, they arrived in the presence of the Blessed One. Then

each individual great bodhisattva scattered and strewed upon the Tathāgata an uncountable, inexpressible ocean-mass of gnosis in the form of clouds of the sovereign lord of precious jewels, extending over a space equal to ten great trichiliocosms. Having scattered and strewed these offerings, they circumambulated the Blessed One an incalculable number of times and took their places to one side.

Just as it was in the eastern direction, so too was it in the south, the west, and the north. So too in the southeast, so too in the southwest, so too in the northwest, so too in the northeast, so too above, and so too below. From each of those oceans of world-realms that had been illuminated by those light-rays, there arrived an ocean of bodhisattvas — an ocean of world-realms' worth of bodhisattvas, equal in number to the finest particles of dust in fifty Ganges rivers, each such particle multiplied by a hundred thousand koṭis, by a trillion, by an incalculable number.

Each of those bodhisattvas was accompanied by a retinue that was itself an ocean of bodhisattvas — an ocean of world-realms' worth of bodhisattvas, equal in number to the finest particles of dust in fifty Ganges rivers, each such particle multiplied by a hundred thousand koṭis, by a trillion, by an incalculable number. And yet — what need is there to speak of a retinue equal in number to the finest particles of dust in ten buddha-fields multiplied by a hundred thousand koṭis, by a trillion, by an inexpressible number? What need to speak of a retinue equal to the finest particles of dust in a hundred world-realms? What need to speak of a retinue equal to the finest particles of dust in fifty world-realms? What need to speak of a retinue equal to the finest particles of dust in twenty-five world-realms? What need to speak of a retinue equal to the finest particles of dust in ten world-realms? What need to speak of a retinue equal to the finest particles of dust in five world-realms? What need to speak of a retinue equal to the finest particles of dust in a single world-realm? What need to speak of a retinue equal in number to the grains of sand in a single Ganges river? What need to speak of a retinue of a hundred koṭis? What need to speak of a retinue of fifty koṭis? What need to speak of a retinue of twenty-five koṭis? What need to speak of a retinue of ten koṭis? What need to speak of a retinue of five koṭis? Indeed, what need is there even to speak of a retinue of a single koṭi of bodhisattvas, great beings?

And each one of those bodhisattvas, individually, released over the sky — filling it throughout, free of attachment, free of obscuration, and unmixed — a rain of clouds of the sovereign among precious jewels, clouds that proclaimed

an ocean beyond counting of the perfections, covering a span equal to ten great trichiliocosms. Then they proceeded toward where the Blessed One was and arrived there. And each bodhisattva, individually, scattered and strewed upon the Tathāgata a ground-cloud of the sovereign among precious jewels, proclaiming an ocean beyond counting of the perfections, covering a span equal to ten great trichiliocosms. Having scattered and strewed it thus, they bowed their heads to the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated him an incalculable number of times, and then took their places to one side.

At that very time, in each of the ten directions, from each ocean of world-realms — equal in number to the finest particles of dust in fifty Ganges rivers, each multiplied by a hundred thousand koṭis, by a trillion, by an incalculable number — there came to dwell, upon each finest particle of dust of each individual world-realm, an ocean of bodhisattvas equal in number to the finest particles of dust in fifty Ganges rivers, each multiplied by a hundred thousand koṭis, by a trillion, by an incalculable number. Yet they caused no harm or obstruction to any sentient being whatsoever. They caused no harm or obstruction to world-realms, to continents, to Sumerus, to great Sumerus, to ranges of lesser mountains, to great ranges of lesser mountains, to snow mountains, to great snow mountains, to encircling iron walls, to great encircling iron walls, to oceans, to great oceans, to the abodes of the gods, to nāgas, to lakes, to small lakes, to villages, to towns, to market settlements, to districts, to provinces, or to royal palaces. Just as things had been before, so they continued to function thereafter exactly as before.

Moreover, the bodhisattvas each beheld the Tathāgata present before them in direct perception, in accordance with their own aspiration and the manner of their training. Why was this? Because he possesses the unshared qualities.

Then the retinue of the bodhisattva Samantabhadra, and certain other bodhisattvas, reflected in their minds: "The Blessed One, from within all the world-realms of the ten directions, skilled in manifold methods within those realms that are afflicted — drawing together the conduct of the world, the wisdom, the vision, and the

constituents, causes, referents, definitive words, designations, and modes of presentation — through the power of the blessing, ripening sentient beings into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening — are all of those present in this assembly, or are there others still absent?

Then the Blessed One, knowing with his mind the full range of those bodhisattvas' thoughts, addressed the bodhisattva mahāsattva Samantabhadra:

"O child of the Victors, consider this: imagine a great ocean of great śrāvakas, endowed with supernatural power and reveling in higher knowledge, as numerous as the finest dust-particles — hundreds of millions of billions of countless such particles — equal to the number of world-realms as numerous as the atoms in the sand-grains of fifty Ganges rivers. And each one of those great śrāvakas, in each moment of a single arising of mind, generates an ocean of arisings of mind as numerous as those same countless hundreds of millions of billions of finest dust-particles equal to the sand-grains of fifty Ganges rivers. And with each such arising of mind each great śrāvaka takes a step, and each step traverses an ocean of world-realms as numerous as those same countless hundreds of millions of billions of finest dust-particles equal to the sand-grains of fifty Ganges rivers. And for each single step taken, he passes through an ocean of world-realms as numerous as those same countless hundreds of millions of billions of finest dust-particles equal to the sand-grains of fifty Ganges rivers. In this manner — such that wherever one great śrāvaka goes, no second one goes — they travel for an ocean of eons as numerous as those same countless hundreds of millions of billions of finest dust-particles equal to the sand-grains of fifty Ganges rivers. This applies equally to the east, to the south, the west, and the north, and likewise to the southeast, the southwest, the northwest, and the northeast. No two great śrāvakas go to the same realm.

Now imagine that someone takes all those oceans of world-realms, makes them into a single city, encloses them entirely with a wall reaching to the summit of existence, levels the ground so that it is as flat as the palm of a hand — free of rocks, gravel, and ridges — fills it with sand, and heaps it up to the brim. Then that person takes the sand grain by grain from that city of sand, and for as many grains of sand as exist within that city, scatters them one by one, counting thus until every last grain has been scattered. Then that person carries all of those scattered sand grains off to the east — traversing, for each scattered grain, an ocean of world-realms as numerous as those same countless hundreds of millions of billions of finest dust-particles equal to the sand-grains of fifty Ganges rivers — and deposits them there one by one, counting thus until every last scattered grain has been deposited. As was done to the east, so too to the south, the west, the north, the southeast, the

southwest, the northwest, and the northeast.

Then that person takes all those oceans of world-realms into which the scattered grains were deposited, together with all those oceans of world-realms into which no grain was deposited, and makes them all into a single city.

That city is enclosed all the way to the summit of existence by a wall, leveled flat as the palm of a hand, free of stones, gravel, and uneven ground, filled with sand and made perfectly smooth. All the bodhisattvas of my retinue assembled here amount to no more than a single grain of sand from that city of sand. The bodhisattvas not assembled here are equal in number to all the remaining grains of sand within that city. And every last one of those bodhisattvas and great beings, as numerous as those remaining grains of sand, shares the same name and the same clan — to say nothing of those with different names and different clans. Every single one of those bodhisattvas is endowed with having attained the meditative absorption of courageous advance, having attained the *dhāraṇī* that accomplishes the endless, fully perfected colors of a buddha's body, having revealed the arising of buddhas in countless fully purified world-realms, having thoroughly purified all afflicted world-realms, and being the supreme herd that ripens the inconceivably vast ocean of sentient beings.

Then the retinue of bodhisattvas thought to themselves: how wonderful it would be for us to see even some among those bodhisattvas who are the supreme herd that ripens sentient beings. And so the Blessed One gathered those bodhisattvas into that very assembly, and in order to reveal their being the supreme herd that ripens sentient beings, he made the sound of a bell.

At that moment, the oceans of world-realms in all directions beyond the outermost rim of the oceans of world-realms from which those bodhisattvas had assembled into that retinue — world-realms as numerous as the finest dust-particles counted in countless hundreds of millions of billions equal to the sand-grains of fifty Ganges rivers — all those oceans of world-realms shook, shook greatly, shook everywhere and greatly; they trembled, trembled greatly, trembled everywhere and greatly; they quaked, quaked greatly, quaked everywhere and greatly; they rocked, rocked greatly, rocked everywhere and greatly; they rumbled, rumbled greatly, rumbled everywhere and greatly; they roared, roared greatly, roared everywhere and greatly. And in each and every world-realm within those oceans of world-realms, when the

east was low the west was high, when the west was low the east was high; when the south was low the north was high, when the north was low the south was high; when the northeast was low the southwest was high, when the southwest was low the northeast was high; when the southeast was low the northwest was high, when the northwest was low the southeast was high; when the edges were low the center was high, and when the center was low the edges were high. As it was in the east, so too it was in the south, so too in the west, so too in the north, in the southeast, the southwest, the northwest, the northeast, and likewise in the directions above and below.

And yet further beyond the outermost rim of those oceans of world-realms from which those bodhisattvas had assembled into that retinue, further still beyond even those —

there trembled, greatly trembled, and trembled throughout; there shook, greatly shook, and shook throughout; there heaved, greatly heaved, and heaved throughout; there rocked, greatly rocked, and rocked throughout; there quaked, greatly quaked, and quaked throughout; there resounded, greatly resounded, and resounded throughout — an ocean of world-realms as numerous as the finest dust-particles that would result from grinding down one hundred thousand myriads of koṭis of countless oceans of world-realms equal in number to the finest dust-particles of fifty Ganges rivers. And in each and every world-realm within that ocean of world-realms, when the east was low the west was high, when the west was low the east was high, when the south was low the north was high, when the north was low the south was high, when the northeast was low the southwest was high, when the southwest was low the northeast was high, when the southeast was low the northwest was high, when the northwest was low the southeast was high, when the edges were low the center was high, and when the center was low the edges were high.

Then at that time, from all ten directions surrounding the maṇḍala of the Tathāgata's retinue, in each and every world-realm within those oceans of world-realms — as numerous as the finest dust-particles that would result from grinding down one hundred thousand myriads of koṭis of countless oceans of world-realms equal in number to the finest dust-particles of fifty Ganges rivers — in each single one of those world-realms, in each single finest dust-particle, there came to abide an ocean of world-realms as numerous as the finest dust-particles of fifty Ganges rivers ground into one hundred thousand myriads of koṭis of countless dust-particles. And those world-realms were encircled by

platforms of Jambū-river gold adorned with precious jewels, made beautiful with lattices of precious gems, with parasols, victory banners, and pennants raised aloft, draped with hanging nets of bell-garlands, anointed with the heartwood of sandalwood and serpent-wood, and covered over with nets woven of the sovereign of precious jewels. Great precious gems of lapis lazuli were painted there in designs visible from afar, and from every quarter of those jeweled nets there hung pearl garlands of many colors and many hues — one hundred thousand myriads of koṭis, immeasurable and countless. Garlands of precious gems of many colors and many hues — one hundred thousand myriads of koṭis, immeasurable and countless — hung there. Silk streamers of many colors and many hues — one hundred thousand myriads of koṭis, immeasurable and countless — hung there. Cotton streamers of many colors and many hues — one hundred thousand myriads of koṭis, immeasurable and countless — hung there. Silk banners of many colors and many hues — one hundred thousand myriads of koṭis, immeasurable and countless — hung there. And bell-garland nets of many colors and many hues — one hundred thousand myriads of koṭis, immeasurable and countless — hung there.

When the wind touched those garlands of precious gems and those pearl garlands, they gave forth divinely pleasing sounds — and the sound that arose when the wind touched those garlands of precious gems and pearl garlands was of such a kind that even a master musician who played instruments of incomparable beauty, one hundred thousand myriads of koṭis of them struck together, could not produce a sound so melodious as that. From those bell-garland strings too, when touched by wind, sounds arose that were divinely pleasing and profound —

and that sound, deep and pleasing as it was, would not arise even from a golden vessel the size of Jambudvīpa struck with a mallet.

From each and every window there stood a jewel tree, each one encircled by jeweled terraces, adorned beautifully with gems, pearls, and precious garlands; canopies, victory banners, and pennants were raised above them; they were decked with immeasurable, countless garland ornaments of precious jewel strings, and adorned equally with immeasurable, countless garland ornaments of pearl strings. They were adorned further with immeasurable, countless garland ornaments of cloth streamers, immeasurable, countless garland ornaments of flower streamers, and immeasurable, countless garland ornaments woven of bell-strings.

At the foot of each and every jewel tree there stood a jeweled lion throne five hundred leagues in height, encircled by jeweled terraces, adorned beautifully with gems, pearls, and precious garlands; canopies, victory banners, and pennants were raised above them; nets of bell-strings were spread as canopies over them; they were anointed with the heartwood of serpent sandalwood. Spread about them were flowers: mândārava, great mândārava, mañjūṣaka, great mañjūṣaka, fair-colored, greatly fair-colored, cakra, great cakra, snā-ma, vārṣika, tāruṇī, valli, gotaraṇī, the supremely fragrant, dānuskari, divine snā-ma, utpala, padma, kumuda, white lotus, and great flowers. They were adorned with immeasurable, countless garland ornaments of precious lightning-lamp gems; with immeasurable, countless garland ornaments of precious sun-and-moon-lamp gems; with immeasurable, countless garland ornaments of precious all-light-gathering gems; with immeasurable, countless garland ornaments of precious sovereign-of-powers gems; with garland ornaments of precious maned gems; with garland ornaments of precious lion-maned gems; with garland ornaments of precious lion-victory-banner gems; with garland ornaments of precious gems borne by Śakra (Indra, king of the gods); with garland ornaments of precious all-gods-light gems; with garland ornaments of precious vajra-light gems; with garland ornaments of precious lotus-sword gems; with garland ornaments of precious water-crest gems; with garland ornaments of precious vaidūrya gems; with garland ornaments of precious andara-gleam gems. They were adorned also with garland ornaments of precious stone-essence gems; with garland ornaments of precious splendor-essence gems; with garland ornaments of precious beautiful-array gems. They were adorned with garland ornaments of white pearls; with garland ornaments of elevated pearls; with garland ornaments of yellow pearls; with garland ornaments of red pearls; with garland ornaments of gold-colored pearls; with garland ornaments of sky-colored pearls.

And from each and every face of each pearl grain, and from each and every face of each precious gem grain, in every single instant of mind there streamed forth clouds of light-rays — immeasurable, countless, incomparable —

immeasurable and boundless. From certain clouds of those oceans of light-rays there streamed forth proclamations revealing the distinctions of innumerable oceans of differentiated accumulations of merit. From certain clouds of those oceans of light-rays there streamed forth proclamations

revealing the distinctions of innumerable oceans of differentiated accumulations of wisdom (jñāna). From certain clouds of those oceans of light-rays there streamed forth proclamations revealing the distinctions of innumerable oceans of differentiated perfections (pāramitās). From certain clouds of those oceans of light-rays there streamed forth proclamations revealing the distinctions of innumerable oceans of differentiated grounds (bhūmis). From certain clouds of those oceans of light-rays there streamed forth proclamations revealing the distinctions of innumerable oceans of differentiated dhāraṇīs. From certain clouds of those oceans of light-rays there streamed forth proclamations revealing the distinctions of innumerable oceans of differentiated liberations (vimokṣas). From certain clouds of those oceans of light-rays there streamed forth proclamations revealing the distinctions of innumerable oceans of differentiated analytical knowledges (pratisaṃvids). From certain clouds of those oceans of light-rays there streamed forth proclamations revealing the distinctions of innumerable oceans of differentiated superknowledges (abhijñās). From certain clouds of those oceans of light-rays there streamed forth proclamations revealing the distinctions of innumerable oceans of differentiated aspirational prayers. From certain clouds of those oceans of light-rays there streamed forth proclamations revealing the distinctions of innumerable oceans of differentiated undertakings of diligence. From certain clouds of those oceans of light-rays there streamed forth proclamations revealing the distinctions of innumerable oceans of differentiated attainments of relief and refreshment. From certain clouds of those oceans of light-rays there streamed forth proclamations revealing the distinctions of innumerable oceans of differentiated modes of entry into the bodhisattva way. From certain clouds of those oceans of light-rays there streamed forth proclamations revealing the distinctions of innumerable oceans of differentiated modes of entry into the Tathāgata way. From certain clouds of those oceans of light-rays there streamed forth proclamations revealing the distinctions of innumerable oceans of differentiated modes of entry into the intentions and conduct of sentient beings. From certain clouds of those oceans of light-rays there streamed forth proclamations revealing the distinctions of innumerable oceans of differentiated modes of entry into world-realms. From certain clouds of those oceans of light-rays there streamed forth proclamations revealing the distinctions of innumerable oceans of differentiated modes of entry into eons (kalpas).

Then at that time all the oceans of world-realms in the eastern direction moved, greatly moved, and moved in every way; they trembled, greatly trembled, and trembled in every way; they rocked, greatly rocked, and rocked in every way; they quaked, greatly quaked, and quaked in every way; they were stirred up, greatly stirred up, and stirred up in every way; they resounded, greatly resounded, and resounded in every way.

Then from each and every one of those oceans of world-realms there arrived bodhisattvas numbering as many as the finest particles of dust of a hundred thousand myriads of koṭis of innumerable world-realms equal in number to the finest dust-particles of fifty Gaṅgā rivers. The retinue of each and every one of those great bodhisattvas also arrived, likewise numbering as many as the finest particles of dust of a hundred thousand myriads of koṭis of innumerable oceans of world-realms equal in number to the finest dust-particles of fifty Gaṅgā rivers. And each and every bodhisattva caused to rain down — without attachment, covering a range of ten great trichiliocosms — immeasurable oceans of clouds of dhāraṇī, sovereign among precious jewels (maṇiratnādhirāja),

filling, without attachment, without obscuration, and without mixture, the expanse of sky, they proceeded to where the Blessed One was and arrived. And each and every one of those bodhisattvas caused to rain down — without attachment, without obscuration, and without mixture — immeasurable oceans of clouds of the meditative absorption of the sovereign among precious jewels (maṇiratnādhirāja), beyond expression, covering a range of ten great trichiliocosms, filling the entire expanse of sky. They scattered these offerings upon the Tathāgata, and scattered them before him, and scattered them most completely before him. Having scattered, and scattered before, and scattered most completely before, they bowed with their heads to the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated him countless times, and then took their seats, each upon his own lion throne arisen from his own aspiration.

Just as it was from the eastern direction, so too from the south, the west, the north, the southeast, the southwest, the northwest, the northeast, and from above and below — all the oceans of world-realms in each of those directions trembled, quaked greatly, quaked completely and greatly, shook, shook greatly, shook completely and greatly, heaved, heaved greatly, heaved completely and greatly, rocked, rocked greatly, rocked completely and greatly, roared, roared greatly, and roared completely and greatly.

From each and every one of those world-realms there arrived an ocean of bodhisattvas as numerous as the finest dust-particles of a hundred thousand myriads of koṭis of innumerable world-realms equal in number to the finest dust-particles of fifty Gaṅgā rivers. The retinue of each and every one of those bodhisattvas likewise arrived, numbering as many as the finest dust-particles of a hundred thousand myriads of koṭis of innumerable oceans of world-realms equal in number to the finest dust-particles of fifty Gaṅgā rivers. And each and every one of those bodhisattvas caused to rain down — without attachment, without obscuration, and without mixture — immeasurable oceans of clouds of various kinds of the sovereign among precious jewels, beyond expression, covering a range of ten great trichiliocosms, filling the entire expanse of sky, and proceeded to where the Blessed One was and arrived. And each and every one of those bodhisattvas then scattered upon the Tathāgata — without attachment, without obscuration, and without mixture, covering a range of ten great trichiliocosms — immeasurable oceans of clouds of the individual thorough knowledge of the sovereign among precious jewels, beyond expression. Having scattered, and scattered before, and scattered most completely before, they bowed with their heads to the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated him countless times, and then each took his seat upon his own lion throne arisen from his own aspiration.

Then at that time, from each of the Blessed One's crown protrusion (uṣṇīṣa), his curl of hair between the brows (ūrṇā), his major marks, his minor excellent marks, and from each of his pores, there arose oceans upon oceans of bodhisattvas — in number exceeding by far even the finest dust-particles of the ocean of world-realms equal in number to the finest dust-particles of a hundred thousand myriads of koṭis of innumerable world-realms equal in number to the finest dust-particles of fifty Gaṅgā rivers. All of those bodhisattvas had bodies the golden color of the river Jambū, their magnificence surpassing that of a hundred thousand myriads of koṭis of innumerable suns; they reveled in the meditative absorption of the heroic march; they had attained the dhāraṇī that accomplishes the boundless and thorough perfection of the bodily complexion of a buddha; and they manifested the arising of buddhas in world-realms where no buddha dwells, entirely purifying all afflicted world-realms. They were seated — every one of them — upon lotus thrones. Each and every lotus was adorned with all precious jewels, had a stalk of many kinds, was furnished with calyxes of precious jewels and arrayed with golden petals, possessed a magnificent and

expansive form, and was endowed with a heart of gold from the river Jambū.

Their lotus thrones emanated maṇḍalas of many-hued light, making clouds of radiance appear in every direction. Rays of light, arranged on all sides, shone forth as the light-rays that proclaim the speech of boundless buddha-realms; and they were made beautiful by scattering profusions of jewel, pearl, and precious-gem garlands. Parasols, victory banners, and pennants were raised in great abundance.

Then those bodhisattvas released oceans of light-rays — hundreds of thousands of tens of millions of immeasurable, uncountable rays — and descended from those lotus thrones. Clouds of divine parasols, clouds of victory banners, clouds of pennants, clouds of flowers, clouds of incense, clouds of precious jewels, clouds of musical sound, clouds of ornaments, clouds of the crests of lion-victory-banners, and clouds of divine cymbals, of striking instruments, and of melodious song — all these, unobstructed, unimpeded, and unmixed, extending to the measure of ten great trichiliocosms, were scattered, thoroughly scattered, and abundantly scattered upon those bodhisattvas. Having scattered, thoroughly scattered, and abundantly scattered these offerings, the bodhisattvas circumambulated innumerable times, bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated again innumerable times, and took their seats upon their own respective lotus thrones. All those bodhisattvas, every one, had come from oceans of world-realms contained within the body of the Tathāgata; and all of them, without exception, had been fully ripened by those bodhisattvas toward unsurpassed, genuinely perfect awakening.

Then the assembled retinue thought: "How wonderful it would be if we could behold, through the power of the buddhas, those world-realms contained within the body of the Tathāgata." Thereupon the Blessed One, knowing with his mind the entire range of thought in the minds of those bodhisattvas, caused to emerge from his crown protrusion a ray of light called "Revealer of the World-Realms Contained within the Body of the Tathāgata," together with a retinue of innumerable rays of light. These rays pervaded all the immeasurable world-realms in the ten directions with a great radiance, reduced all the abodes of māras to utter darkness, and displayed all the miraculous transformations of buddhas. Then, having fully ripened the limitless realm of sentient beings, those rays returned, circumambulated the Tathāgata — the arhat, the genuinely and perfectly awakened buddha — innumerable times, and came to rest upon the bodies of those bodhisattvas.

The very instant that ray of light touched the bodies of those bodhisattvas, each and every one of them, in that very moment, beheld — within each curl of white hair between the Blessed One's brows, within his crown protrusion, within each of his major marks, within each of his excellent minor marks, and within each of his pores — an ocean of world-realms as vast and numerous as the finest atoms produced by grinding, into dust as fine as can be, hundreds of thousands of tens of millions of immeasurable, uncountable oceans of world-realms each equal in number to the grains of sand of fifty rivers like the Gaṅgā; and yet that ocean-vast number of world-realms is to be regarded as only a single one of the finest dust-particles within the enclosure I shall describe, while the world-realms far exceeding that number in those same oceans of world-realms they saw being destroyed by fire, by water, and by wind. It is like this: take oceans of world-realms as numerous as the finest atoms produced by grinding to dust hundreds of thousands of tens of millions of immeasurable, uncountable oceans of world-realms each equal in number to the grains of sand of the river Gaṅgā; let these world-realms extend all the way to the summit of existence, be enclosed by a perimeter wall, be free of rocks, gravel, and weeds, be level as the palm of a hand, and be filled with finest dust-particles — then the world-realms in which one sees destruction by fire, destruction by water, and destruction by wind are to be regarded as a single finest dust-particle within that enclosure.

Within those oceans of world-realms, the world-realms that remain are to be regarded as being in number equal to the remaining finest dust-particles.

Among those oceans of world-realms, some are composed of precious jewels made of starlight. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels made of lightning-lamps. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels made of the light of the sun and moon. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels made of the gathered radiance of all lights. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels made of the sovereign of powers. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels made of stamens. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels made of lion's stamens. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels made of the tip of a lion's vajra. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels borne by Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods). Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels made of the radiance of all the gods. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels made of vajra-light. Some

oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels made of padmarāga ruby. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels made of water-crystal. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of wish-fulfilling precious jewels. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels made of vaidūrya lapis lazuli. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels made of andaranīla blue sapphire. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels made of great matonka. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels made of the essence of stone. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels made of the essence of splendor. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels of beautiful arrangement. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of white pearls. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of golden-hued pearls. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of sky-colored pearls. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels spoken of as displaying the innumerable distinctions of an ocean of accumulations of merit. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels spoken of as displaying the innumerable distinctions of an ocean of accumulations of primordial wisdom. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels spoken of as displaying the innumerable distinctions of an ocean of perfections. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels spoken of as displaying the innumerable distinctions of an ocean of precious jewels. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels spoken of as displaying the innumerable distinctions of an ocean of dhāraṇīs. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels spoken of as displaying the innumerable distinctions of an ocean of liberations.

Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels spoken of as displaying the innumerable distinctions of an ocean of precise and thorough understanding. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels spoken of as displaying the innumerable distinctions of an ocean of direct knowledge (abhijñā). Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels spoken of as displaying the innumerable distinctions of an ocean of aspirational prayers. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels spoken of as displaying the innumerable distinctions of an ocean of the undertaking of diligence. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels spoken of as displaying the innumerable distinctions of an ocean of attainment of relief and refreshment. Some oceans of world-realms

are composed of precious jewels spoken of as displaying the innumerable distinctions of an ocean of entering into bodhisattvas. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels spoken of as displaying the innumerable distinctions of an ocean of entering into the Tathāgatas. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels spoken of as displaying the innumerable distinctions of an ocean of entering into the intentions and conduct of sentient beings. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels spoken of as displaying the innumerable distinctions of an ocean of entering into world-realms. Some oceans of world-realms are composed of precious jewels spoken of as displaying the innumerable distinctions of an ocean of entering into eons.

In some oceans of world-realms, within each and every dust-mote of those world-realms there appear inconceivable buddha-fields dwelling in manifold array, as many as the dust-motes of all buddha-fields. And within each of those fields, there appear inconceivable Blessed Ones, buddhas, dwelling in colors as many as the dust-motes of all buddha-fields. Those Blessed Ones, buddhas, also appear — the very ones who, when those bodhisattvas were formerly practicing the bodhisattva conduct, caused them to arouse the mind of awakening and taught them the bodhisattva conduct. And there too appear the Blessed Ones, buddhas, who caused those Blessed Ones, buddhas, in turn to arouse the mind of awakening when they themselves were formerly practicing the bodhisattva conduct. And so in this way, even were one to show the succession of Blessed Ones, buddhas, one from another all the way to the furthest end, one could never show the limit of that succession from buddha to buddha. Around each and every Blessed One, buddha, there appear immeasurable and innumerable oceans of assemblies of retinues. The manifold presentations of those bodhisattvas' ocean of bodhisattva conduct are also heard. The perfect and complete awakening of those bodhisattvas also appears. The oceans of assemblies of those bodhisattvas' retinues also appear. The manifold presentations of those bodhisattvas' ocean of conduct in awakening are also heard. The perfect and complete awakening of those bodhisattvas also appears. And around each and every Blessed One, buddha, there appear immeasurable and innumerable oceans of assemblies of retinues of bodhisattvas.

The manifold presentations of those bodhisattvas' conduct are also seen and heard.

Likewise, even were one to expound, buddha by buddha in succession, the Blessed Ones who are the buddhas of the future — for a span equal to as many aeons as there are atoms in all world-systems of an ocean of world-systems — one would still never reach the end. And why is that? Because they have attained a body and a wisdom that are without attachment.

Then the bodhisattvas of that retinue thought to themselves: "How great must be the accumulation of merit for those bodhisattvas who, upon hearing this enumeration of the Dharma, give rise to faith in it, retain it, recite it, teach it to others, and make offerings to it with lamps, incense, perfumes, garlands of flowers, unguents, powders, Dharma robes, parasols, victory banners, pennants, and the like?"

Then the Blessed One, knowing with his mind the full range of those bodhisattvas' thoughts, spoke to the youthful Mañjuśrī: "Mañjuśrī, however many oceans of world-systems there are whose atoms number in the hundreds of millions of trillions of immeasurable, innumerable atoms of world-systems — as many as fifty times the grains of sand of the Gaṅgā river — that number of atoms is exceedingly few. Far more numerous are the oceans of bodhisattvas whose roots of virtue arising from the five perfections have been cultivated for immeasurable and innumerable aeons. And yet even that is surpassed by the merit of a bodhisattva who has faith in this enumeration of the Dharma, even one who has been born in the realm of animals, who has given away so much as a single morsel of food. That single act of giving surpasses the roots of virtue arising from the five perfections of all those bodhisattvas combined.

"Mañjuśrī, consider this example: on the night of the fifteenth day of the waxing moon, at midnight, the full orb of the moon, by its height, its incomparability, and its greatness, outshines the entire retinue of stars, shining brilliantly, radiantly, and in full splendor. In just the same way, Mañjuśrī, a bodhisattva who has faith in this enumeration of the Dharma, with roots of virtue so lofty, so incomparable, and so great, outshines the roots of virtue arising from the five perfections of bodhisattvas as numerous as the atoms of all world-systems combined, shining brilliantly, radiantly, and in full splendor.

"Mañjuśrī, consider a case in which someone strikes every single sentient being in the great trichiliocosm with a club, wounds them with weapons, and

seizes all their possessions. Mañjuśrī, should another bodhisattva then arouse toward a bodhisattva a mind of malice, contempt, or anger, and further arouse a mind of disdain — that second act accumulates far greater demerit than the first. And why is that? Because when a bodhisattva arouses toward another bodhisattva a mind of malice, contempt, anger, or disdain, that bodhisattva has committed an act that will result in being deprived of the Dharma, and will come to fully embrace what is not the Dharma. To fully embrace what is not the Dharma is to cut the lineage of the buddhas. If buddhas were not to arise, the divine hosts of the Four Great Kings would not come into being. The gods of the Thirty-Three would not arise, nor those of the Heaven Free from Strife, nor those of Tuṣita, nor those of Nirmāṇarati, nor those of Paranirmitavaśavartin, nor the hosts of the māras. Śakra (Indra) would not arise, nor Brahmā, nor"

nor any of the world-protectors would come into being. No moons or suns would arise. Wheel-turning kings (cakravartins) and kings who turn the wheel by power would not come into being. The human world would not arise. Why is that? Because all of these arise from an encounter with a fully awakened buddha, and the blessed buddhas themselves arise from bodhisattvas.

Therefore, one who wishes to make offerings to all buddhas should make offerings to bodhisattvas. If one makes offerings to bodhisattvas, that becomes an offering to all buddhas. If one pays honor to bodhisattvas, that becomes honor paid to all buddhas.

Mañjuśrī, consider a bodhisattva who offers divine food of a hundred flavors, together with divine garments, to the Blessed One — the buddha — in a number equal to the dust-motes of all buddha-fields throughout the universe, and continues such giving for a span of aeons equal in number to the dust-motes of as many world-systems as there are grains of sand in the Ganges. Now consider another bodhisattva who, by focusing on a bodhisattva — using any object of focus whatsoever, whether incense, a lamp, a flower, perfume, or anything else at all — generates the awakening mind directed toward full awakening. This latter act gives rise to merit that is immeasurably and incomparably greater than the former. What need is there even to speak of one who leads others to generate it? This generates merit that is immeasurably greater still. The former accumulation of merit cannot approach a hundredth part of this accumulation, nor a thousandth, nor a hundred-thousandth, nor a ten-millionth, nor a billion-times-tenth part, nor a trillion-times-tenth part, nor a hundred-trillion-times-tenth part — it does not

withstand comparison or reckoning.

Mañjuśrī, consider a bodhisattva who establishes all sentient beings in the awakening mind. Now consider another bodhisattva who develops sincere conviction in emptiness. This latter generates merit that is immeasurably greater — and what then need be said of one who leads others to develop such conviction? This generates merit that is immeasurably greater still. The former accumulation of merit cannot approach a hundredth part of this accumulation, nor a thousandth, nor a hundred-thousandth, nor a ten-millionth, nor a billion-times-tenth part, nor a trillion-times-tenth part, nor a hundred-trillion-times-tenth part — it does not withstand comparison or reckoning.

Mañjuśrī, consider a bodhisattva who cuts off a bodhisattva's sustenance, or who in anger severs even a single root of virtue directed toward buddhahood cultivated by that bodhisattva — even were that bodhisattva to have been born as a great elephant. Now consider another bodhisattva who, with anger, deprives all the stream-enterers (those who have entered the stream), once-returners, non-returners, arhats, and pratyekabuddhas throughout all world-systems — as many as dust-motes — of their bowls and their robes, and blinds all sentient beings. The non-virtue of this latter act cannot approach a hundredth part of the non-virtue of the former act — and so on down to: it does not withstand comparison.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, those monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen who were present, together with the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, mahoragas, Śakra (Indra), Brahmā, the world-protectors, and humans —

— and all non-human beings, together with an ocean of innumerable and immeasurable bodhisattvas who had come from the various directions — were filled with joy and gave full praise to what the Blessed One had declared.

This is the thirty-seventh chapter, entitled "The Great Festival of the Ocean of Bodhisattvas Gathered from the Ten Directions," from the great King of Sūtras, the Great Cloud. Each of its chapters contains as many gateways to the appearance of the Dharma as there are grains of sand in innumerable Ganges rivers — assembling them perfectly, illuminated by the lightning-splendor of the maṇḍala of luminous appearance — and this vast gathering of great chapters, by the power of its force of engagement that accords with innumerable worlds such as Tuṣita and the rest, exercises sovereignty. Fully

complete.

This was revised and definitively established by the Indian master Surendrabodhi and the great editor-translator, the monk Yeshé Dé.

Translator's Notes

- The Sanskrit title given in the colophon identifies this as a chapter (parivarta) from the Mahāmegha-sūtra. The Tibetan chapter title rendered here as "The Great Festival in Which the Ocean of Bodhisattvas from the Ten Directions Gathers and Takes Delight" follows the Tibetan closely; the Sanskrit reconstruction in the colophon supports this reading.

The name "Prajāpatī" renders རྒྱལ་པོའི་མཆོད་པོ་, which is a Tibetan calque of Mahāprajāpatī, the foster-mother of the Buddha and the first fully ordained nun; this identification is secure in context.

The phrase rendered "directly inclined toward the Great Vehicle and had properly entered the Great Vehicle" translates a standard Mahāyāna assembly formula distinguishing those who are oriented toward but not yet fully in the vehicle from those who have entered it properly; here both qualities are attributed to every member of each group.

- The name rendered "Fragrant Elephant" translates the Tibetan dri za'i glang po, literally "the fragrant-one's elephant" or "elephant among the gandharvas," taken here as a proper name for the leading garuḍa king. This is somewhat unusual given that dri za ordinarily means gandharva, but in context the term clearly designates the garuḍa king's name; a slight textual irregularity in the manuscript tradition cannot be ruled out.

The name rendered "Wilderness Dweller" translates 'brog gnas, literally "one who dwells in the wilderness."

The name rendered "Fervent" translates drod ldan, literally "one who possesses heat or ardor."

- The term rendered "Kacchanaka spirits" translates རྒྱལ་པོའི་མཆོད་པོ་, literally "sons of the cutters" or "offspring of the slayers." This appears to be a class of spirit beings whose Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain; the Tibetan name is rendered descriptively here.

The elemental spirit king's name རྒྱལ་པོའི་མཆོད་པོ་ is rendered "Elephant-Heart," meaning "one whose heart or essence is like an elephant," suggesting steadfastness or greatness of spirit.

The number for the elemental spirit kings, རྒྱལ་པོའི་མཆོད་པོ་, is literally "three million and eight hundred thousand," which is an unusual combined figure and is rendered straightforwardly.

- The passage contains a structural repetition characteristic of sūtra prose, with the phrase about joy and delight appearing twice in close succession in the Tibetan. This appears to be deliberate liturgical repetition rather than a scribal error, and has been rendered accordingly.

The kalavinka (Sanskrit: kalaviṅka) is a legendary bird of exceptionally beautiful song, often described in Buddhist texts as surpassing all other birds in the sweetness of its voice. The name has been kept in transliteration as it is a recognized technical term in Buddhist literature.

- The name rendered "Śaṅśaṅteu" (Tibetan: shan shan te'u) is a transcription of a Sanskrit bird name, likely the Indian roller or a similar bird; the exact Sanskrit original is uncertain, but the Tibetan is treated as a proper name throughout and is rendered consistently.

The phrase "rikā'i na bun ita bu" (rendered "One Like the Snows of Rikā") is obscure; "rikā" may be a place name or a transcription of a Sanskrit term, and "na bun" means snow or snowfall. The rendering is approximate and this is a genuinely uncertain proper name.

The term "chu srin byis pa gsod" is literally "the water-creature that kills children," a creature associated with water and harm to the young, here rendered as "the water-spirit that devours children" following the sense of the compound.

- The mountain names Lhunpo, Tang-zung, and Khor-yug are Tibetan renderings of Sanskrit mountain categories. Lhunpo likely corresponds to Meru-type mountains, Tang-zung to mountains held in balance or suspended, and Khor-yug to the outer encircling ring of mountains in Buddhist cosmology. Rendering them in translation as descriptive English could mislead; keeping them as transliterated names with a gloss for Khor-yug as "encircling" seemed the most serviceable approach for the listener.

The name Sarvāvaraṇaviṣkambhin means "the one who removes all obscurations," which is the Sanskrit reconstruction of Tibetan sgrib pa thams cad rnam par sel ba. This is a well-attested bodhisattva name in the Mahāvāna literature.

- The Śākya maiden named is རྒྱལ་ལོ་ལྷ་མོ་, which most likely renders the Sanskrit Yaśodharā, the well-known consort of the Bodhisattva. The name literally means "she who lives from the earth" in Tibetan, but Yaśodharā is the standard identification in the tradition; this is noted here rather than glossed in the body given the continuity format.

The phrase 大日如來降尊闡化, rendered "the Coming of the Great Lord to Pay Homage," refers in context to the Tathāgatas and the Great Lord's act of veneration at their birth, consistent with the biographical sequence being enumerated.

The passage ends mid-sentence with □□□□□□□□, "death, and," indicating continuation in the next passage.

- The phrase rendered as "Summoning of Māra" translates བྱ་བྱེད་ཀྱི་མཁའ་ཁྱེད་, literally "calling/drawing Māra." This likely refers to the traditional narrative episode in which the Buddha-to-be, by the power of his merit and resolve, provokes or draws out Māra and his armies prior to awakening, rather than a literal summoning in a positive sense. The rendering preserves the Tibetan literally; commentators may read it as the arising of Māra's challenge.

The city name कपिलवस्तु is Kapilavastu, rendered accordingly.

- The term rendered as "Finger-Garland" for अङ्गुलिमाला refers to a disease whose name parallels the epithet of the murderer Aṅgulimāla. Whether this is a disease literally named after a garland of fingers or an allusive reference to some epidemic connected with that figure is not determinable from context alone.

The phrase ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་, rendered as "the Nāga King Who Is Without Grass," likely refers to a specific named nāga king; ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ may be a Tibetan rendering of a Sanskrit name meaning "without grass" or "barren," but the precise Sanskrit original is uncertain.

- The passage concerning the beautiful wanderess is particularly compressed. The Tibetan reads that wanderers are disturbed through a beautiful wanderess imposing false superimpositions, which I have rendered as "a Beautiful Wanderess Who Imposes False Accusations," though the term *sgro btags pa* here carries the sense of imputing or superimposing something falsely onto another, possibly meaning she falsely accuses the wanderers of something. The precise social or narrative scenario being evoked is not entirely clear from the text alone.

The term "ltas su bsgos pa," rendered as "Directing to Action," could also be read as "assigning as a task" or "commissioning an act," which is consistent with the preceding entry about deeds

to be performed. The rendering chosen reflects the most natural reading in context.

- The term rendered "the Four Things" translates གཞི་བཅུ་ལྔ་པ་, which could refer to any number of traditional enumerations of four items; without further context from the surrounding sūtra, the precise referent cannot be determined. Similarly, "Things" for གཞི་བཅུ་ལྔ་པ་ and "the Two" for གཞི་གཉིས་ are deliberately left open, as the sūtra's own context would specify what fourfold and twofold categories are intended. "Conceit" renders རྒྱལ་པོ་, which can also carry the sense of pride or presumption; "conceit" is used here as the most common doctrinal equivalent. "Complete affliction" renders རྒྱལ་པོ་ལྔ་པ་, a standard Abhidharma term for the process or state of being thoroughly afflicted or defiled.
- The term rendered "ūrṇā-hair" refers to the tuft of white hair between the brows, one of the major physical marks of a great being. The Tibetan mdzod spru literally means "treasury hair" and is the standard rendering of Sanskrit ūrṇā.

The phrase "ten million hundreds of thousands of times the grains of sand in the Ganges" renders bye ba khrag khrig brgya stong phrag gang gā'i klung gi bye ma snyed, a standard hyperbolic enumeration formula in Mahāyāna sūtras.

The "Goddess Māyā" is Queen Māyādevī, mother of the historical Buddha Śākyamuni; lha mo sgyu 'phrul is a standard Tibetan rendering of her name.

- The text ends mid-sentence with the list "the old, the sick, the dead" — the passage breaks off here and the translation renders exactly what is present. The next item in the traditional list of the "four sights" (a wandering ascetic) would follow in the continuation.

The phrase rendered "Going to Pay Homage to the Great Lord (Śiva)" refers to the young bodhisattva's visit to the Śaiva temple, a standard episode in biographical accounts of the Buddha's early life; the epithet རྒྱལ་པོ་ལྔ་པ་ is Mahāśvara, a name of Śiva.

The Śākya maiden rendered here as Gopā (གཞི་བཅུ་ལྔ་པ་) is the future buddha's consort, known in various sources as Gopā or Yaśodharā; the Tibetan name གཞི་བཅུ་ལྔ་པ་ corresponds to Gopā.

- The term rendered "Summoning Māra" translates གཞི་བཅུ་ལྔ་པ་, literally "drawing forth" or "calling up" Māra. This is a specific deed in the twelve acts of a buddha's life, referring to the episode in which the bodhisattva, seated at the seat of awakening, is confronted by Māra and his hosts. The verb གཞི་བཅུ་ལྔ་པ་ can mean to summon or to draw toward oneself; in context it describes the act of Māra being drawn to challenge the bodhisattva, not an intentional summoning by the bodhisattva. The rendering here follows established usage in the literature of the twelve deeds.
- The term rendered "states of misfortune" translates mi khom pa, literally "lacking leisure" or "inopportune states," the standard Buddhist enumeration of conditions unfavorable for Dharma practice. The phrase is here qualified by nyon mongs pa can dag tu, meaning "those that are afflicted," yielding the sense of inopportune rebirths characterized by affliction.

The "eighty-four poisons" is an unusual enumeration. The number eighty-four here likely corresponds to the eighty-four thousand afflictions or defilements of the traditional Abhidharma reckoning, here condensed symbolically as "poisons." This is a genuinely unusual formulation and its precise doctrinal referent may depend on the specific tantric or sūtra source of this text.

- The name translated as "Sogma-me" renders the Tibetan གཞི་བཅུ་ལྔ་པ་, which appears to be a proper name or epithet of a nāga king. Its exact Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain; it may correspond to a nāga name not readily identified from the Tibetan alone.

The phrase rendered "Brazen Men" translates གཞི་བཅུ་ལྔ་པ་, literally "shameless" or "insolent people," referring to those without shame or moral restraint. The rendering captures the doctrinal sense of persons without conscience.

"Garuḍas" renders གུརུཊ་མཉམ་པ་, the sky-soaring garuḍa birds, the traditional enemies of nāgas in Indian cosmology.

- The phrase rendered "what has come to be seen" translates Ita bar gyur pa, literally "that which has become an object of seeing or view." In this context it functions as an unusual doctrinal formulation: the intrinsic nature of phenomenal appearance as it presents itself to observation is itself emptiness. The rendering is intentionally literal to preserve the philosophical argument's structure, which parallels the preceding destruction passage.

The "Brahmin Girl Who Deceives and Stirs Up All" and "Wanderer Adorned with Beautiful Feathers Who Stirs Up All" are among a long series of enigmatic dispensation-names in this text. Their precise narrative referents are uncertain; they likely allude to episodes known to the text's original audience.

- The term rendered "appointment to a task" translates las su bsko ba, literally "to commission" or "to appoint to a function or role." In this litany of paired concepts, it refers to the notion of assigning a thing a function or purpose. The term is somewhat technical and the rendering is chosen to preserve both its literal sense and its philosophical thrust within the series.

The term rendered "lifting and placing" translates 'deg pa dang 'jog pa, a pair meaning literally "to raise up and to set down." This may refer to the activity of taking up and setting aside, or more broadly to the movement of picking up and putting down — a concrete image for intentional activity or discrimination.

The term rendered "main object" or "principal object" translates dngos gzhi, which can mean "the main matter," "the actual substance," or "the principal focus of an action." In context it appears as yet another item in this enumerative series of apparent dualities whose intrinsic nature is said to be their own absence.

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, as the source text is incomplete at that point. The term rendered "main object" translates རྒྱུ་ལྗོངས་, literally "main basis" or "primary object," continuing consistently with the preceding passage. The term rendered "basis" translates རྒྱུ་, which can mean "abode," "place," or "basis" and is here used in an abstract ontological sense parallel to the other terms in the series. The term rendered "entity" translates རྒྱུ་ལྗོངས་, a standard term for a substantially existing thing or entity. The term rendered "referent object" translates རྒྱུ་ལྗོངས་, the object of mental apprehension or meditative focus, a standard epistemological and meditational term.

- The phrase rendered "thorough defilement" translates kun nas nyon mongs pa, the standard Tibetan equivalent of Sanskrit saṃkleśa, meaning the comprehensive or complete afflictive defilement of the mind-stream. The paradox throughout this passage — that saṃsāra, inexpressibility, defilement, and so forth are themselves "perfectly pure" — follows the characteristic Prajñāpāramitā logic in which the ultimate nature of any phenomenon, even a negative one, is its very purity. The phrase "establishing X" in each petition refers to the Blessed One's blessing-power oriented toward that particular characteristic, serving as the summoning condition for the bodhisattvas.

- The term rendered "conceit" for རྒྱུ་ལྗོངས་ is literally "mind of pride or inflation" and corresponds to the Sanskrit māna or abhimāna. The translation "conceit" is standard in this doctrinal context.

- The phrase rendered "the absence of pride is thoroughly pure" follows the same structural paradox used throughout this passage: the text employs the negation of a quality as itself a subject of further negation, producing the characteristic apophatic spiral. The rendering preserves this deliberately recursive logic.

Sanskrit reconstructions rather than speculative English plant names. The gem-name epithets (lightning-lamp, sun-and-moon-lamp, all-light-gathering, and so forth) are descriptive titles rather than mineralogical identifications and are translated accordingly. The term "andara-gleam" renders a Tibetan transliteration of uncertain Sanskrit original.

- The term rendered "relief and refreshment" translates "dbugs 'byin pa 'thob pa," literally "attaining the drawing of breath" or "gaining respite." In Mahāyāna context this refers to the consolation or relief given to suffering beings, a recognized category alongside the other bodhisattva qualities listed. The rendering aims to capture this nuance for a listening audience.

The sixfold earthquake formula — moved, greatly moved, moved in every way; trembled, greatly trembled, trembled in every way, and so on through six verbs each tripled — is a standard canonical description of cosmic earthquakes accompanying major spiritual events. The six verbs rendered here follow the conventional Tibetan sequence found across sūtra literature.

- The passage contains a highly formulaic series of twelve earthquake-terms rendered in Tibetan triplets of increasing intensity. The translation renders these as a consistent ascending series: trembled, quaked greatly, quaked completely and greatly; shook, shook greatly, shook completely and greatly; and so forth. The exact Sanskrit equivalents underlying the Tibetan would be the standard set found in Mahāyāna sūtras such as kampita, saṃkampita, samantaṃ prakampita, and so on. The rendering here follows standard scholastic convention.

The phrase rendered "individual thorough knowledge" translates a compound meaning something like "individual or distinct analytical understanding" associated with the precious jewel cloud offering, which likely corresponds to a Sanskrit technical term in the dhāraṇī or samādhi context; it has been rendered plainly and accurately as the syntax allows.

- The passage describing what is seen within each pore and mark of the Blessed One involves an elaborate series of nested numerical hyperboles that are genuinely difficult to parse with full syntactic precision. The translation follows the most natural reading of the Tibetan, in which the immense number of world-realms actually witnessed through the Blessed One's marks is set against an even larger hypothetical totality: the worlds seen being destroyed by the three cosmic destructions are as one dust-atom compared to the whole enclosure filled with dust. This cosmological conceit is standard in Avataṃsaka-style literature and is rendered accordingly.

- The gemstone names "andaraṇīla" and "matonka" are transcriptions of Indic terms for which no fully certain Sanskrit equivalents are established in this context. "Andaraṇīla" likely corresponds to a Sanskrit compound meaning "inner blue" or denoting a deep blue sapphire variety; "matonka" or "mthon ka chen po" may render a Sanskrit term for a type of beryl or similar stone. The gem name has been left in approximate transliteration rather than invented.

The phrase rendered "the sovereign of powers" for "dbang gi rgyal po" is literally "king of power or sovereignty," likely a jewel-name of Indic origin whose precise Sanskrit referent is uncertain.

The opening sentence of this passage resumes the comparative counting exercise from the preceding section; its syntactic connection to what came before should be understood as continuous.

- The phrase rendered "precise and thorough understanding" translates བཤམ་པའི་ཤེས་པ་, which corresponds to the Sanskrit pratyavekṣaṇā or, more likely in this cosmological Avataṃsaka context, pratisaṃvid, meaning "individual or analytical knowledge." The rendering "precise and thorough understanding" is chosen to convey the sense of discriminative, analytic cognition while remaining accessible to a listening audience.

The phrase प्राप्तिरुत्थानं, rendered "attainment of relief and refreshment," literally means "obtaining the drawing of breath" and idiomatically conveys a sense of respite, encouragement, or consolation — a recognized quality in Mahāyāna cosmological enumerations. No single English term captures all nuances precisely.

- The passage ends mid-sentence in the source Tibetan, breaking off after "Brahmā, nor." The translation reflects this accurately as the text simply continues beyond the supplied excerpt. The five heavenly realms named are: the Heaven of the Thirty-Three (Trāyastriṃśa), the Heaven Free from Strife (Yāma), Tuṣita, Nirmāṇarati, and Paranirmitavaśavartin — all standard desire-realm divine abodes listed in canonical order. The phrase rendered "shining brilliantly, radiantly, and in full splendor" translates three onomatopoetic Tibetan sound-symbolic particles conveying luminous fullness; no single English phrase perfectly captures this, but the rendering preserves the rhetorical effect.
- The phrase rendered "stream-enterers, once-returners, non-returners, arhats, and pratyekabuddhas" corresponds to Tibetan terms for the eight noble persons in the śrāvaka tradition: those following the Dharma, those following meaning, the stream-enterer, once-returner, non-returner, arhat, and pratyekabuddha. The Tibetan here lists them somewhat compressed; the translation follows the standard eight-plus-one enumeration.

The repeated numerical sequence — hundred, thousand, hundred-thousand, ten-million, and so on — follows the classical Indian large-number series as used throughout the Prajñāpāramitā and related literature. The translation renders each term consistently throughout both parallel passages.

- The phrase rendered "gateways to the appearance of the Dharma" translates a dense colophonic formula describing the chapters as each containing Ganges-sand-many doors of Dharma-illumination. The passage functions as a chapter-closing doxology combining content description with the translator colophon standard to the Tibetan canon. "Tuṣṭita" is identified by the Tibetan name for that heaven realm; it is given here as the most natural rendering of ཐུསྲིཏིཏི་ཁུ་, which in cosmological contexts refers to Tuṣṭita heaven, not to be confused with the Ganden monastery of the same Tibetan name.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.